



RIO DE JANEIRO RACE PREVIEW

Elite Analysis · August 1 – 2, 2026

USA Triathlon High Performance

Race Week Schedule

Rio de Janeiro



August 1 – 2, 2026 • Triathlon Arena, Copacabana Beach, Av Atlântica (BRT, UTC-3)

Sat • Aug 1

Familiarization & Briefing

05:30 – 06:45	Bike course familiarization — Triathlon Arena
06:45 – 07:45	Swim course familiarization — Triathlon Arena
16:00 – 17:00	★ Mandatory Elite Athletes' briefing — Othon Palace

Post-briefing Race pack + credentials distribution

Sun • Aug 2

WORLD CUP RACE DAY

05:30 – 06:30	Elite Women — Athletes' lounge open
06:00 – 06:45	Elite Women — Transition open
06:20 – 06:45	Elite Women — Swim course open for warm-up
06:50 – 06:58	Elite Women — Presentation
07:00	★ ELITE WOMEN RACE START
07:45 – 08:45	Elite Men — Athletes' lounge open
08:00 – 08:45	Elite Men — Transition + swim warm-up
08:50 – 08:58	Elite Men — Presentation
09:00	★ ELITE MEN RACE START

10:30 Elite Men & Women medal ceremony

Times Triathlon Arena, Copacabana Beach, Av Atlântica (BRT, UTC-3). Schedule confirmed from World Triathlon race-info page / athlete guide; subject to organiser updates.



RIO DE JANEIRO

The RIO World Cup returns to Copacabana Beach, the 2016 Olympic triathlon venue for sprint race. A beach-start 750 m ocean swim leads into a flat 6 lap 20.8 km bike along Avenida Atlântica and a 2-lap, 5 km run down the iconic Copacabana promenade. Warm 22–24 °C water means a non-wetsuit swim. Morning starts (Women 07:00, Men 09:00) in Rio's mild August winter.

COURSE FEATURES

- Beach-start 750 m ocean swim off Copacabana. Likely non-wetsuit (22–24 °C).
- Flat 6 lap 20.8 km bike along the Avenida Atlântica seafront. Potential for big packs
- 5 km run (2 laps) on the iconic Copacabana promenade.
- Morning starts (W 07:00 / M 09:00) in mild Rio winter conditions.

COURSE AT A GLANCE

Swim:	750 m – 1 lap
Bike:	20.8 km – 6 laps × 3.47 km
Run:	5 km – 2 laps × 2.5 km
Format:	Sprint Triathlon (World Cup)
Bike Laps:	6
Run Laps:	2

QUICK LINKS

Current Race Info:

[Race Info | 2026 World Triathlon Cup Rio de Janeiro](#)

Course Photos

Edmonton



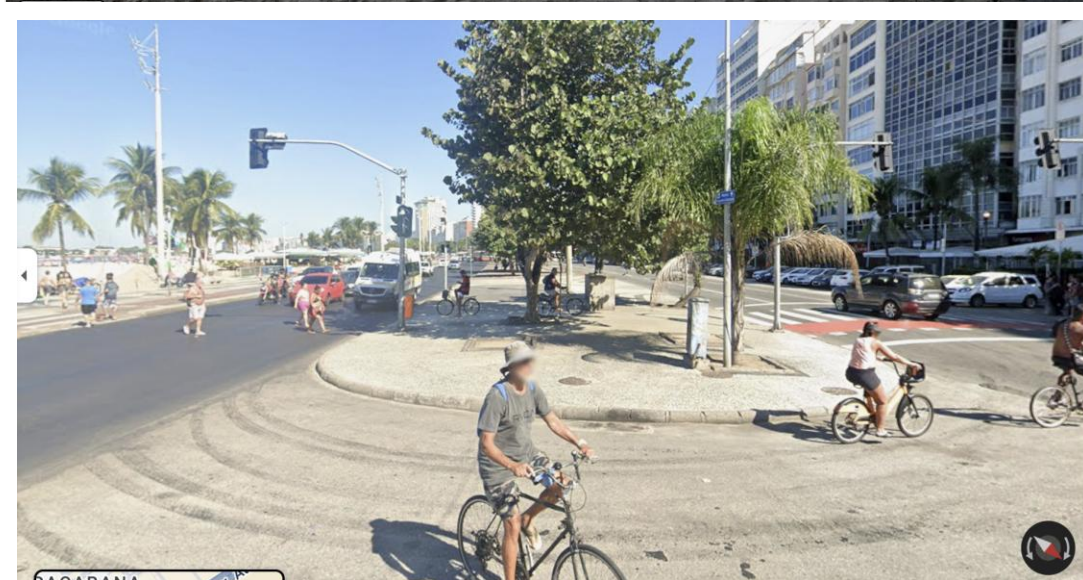
Swim
Area

Transition



Bike
Turnaround

2nd bike
turn (near
transition)



Course Photos

Edmonton



Finish Area
(Lima St)

Run Turnaround
(Open section
after ... Ramos)



Swim Course Profile

Rio de Janeiro



Source: 2026 World Triathlon Cup Rio Athlete's Guide v2.0 (Copacabana)

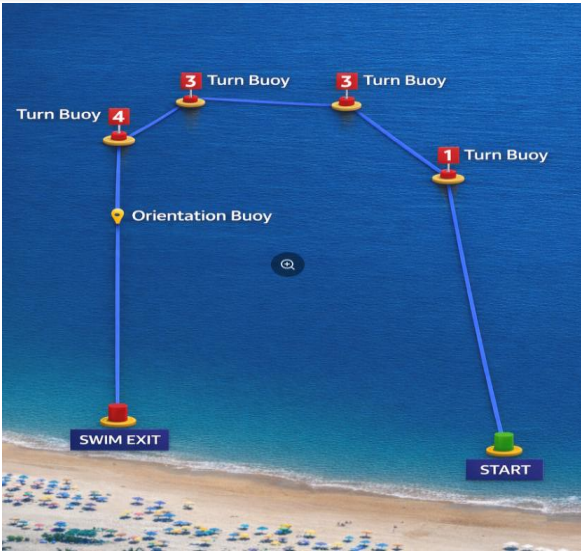
750 m • single lap

Open ocean — Atlantic surf, beach start

Distance 750 m	Layout Copacabana Beach	Start Beach start
Water Temp 22.5 °C (live)	Wetsuit Forbidden (> 22 °C)	Lap Count 1

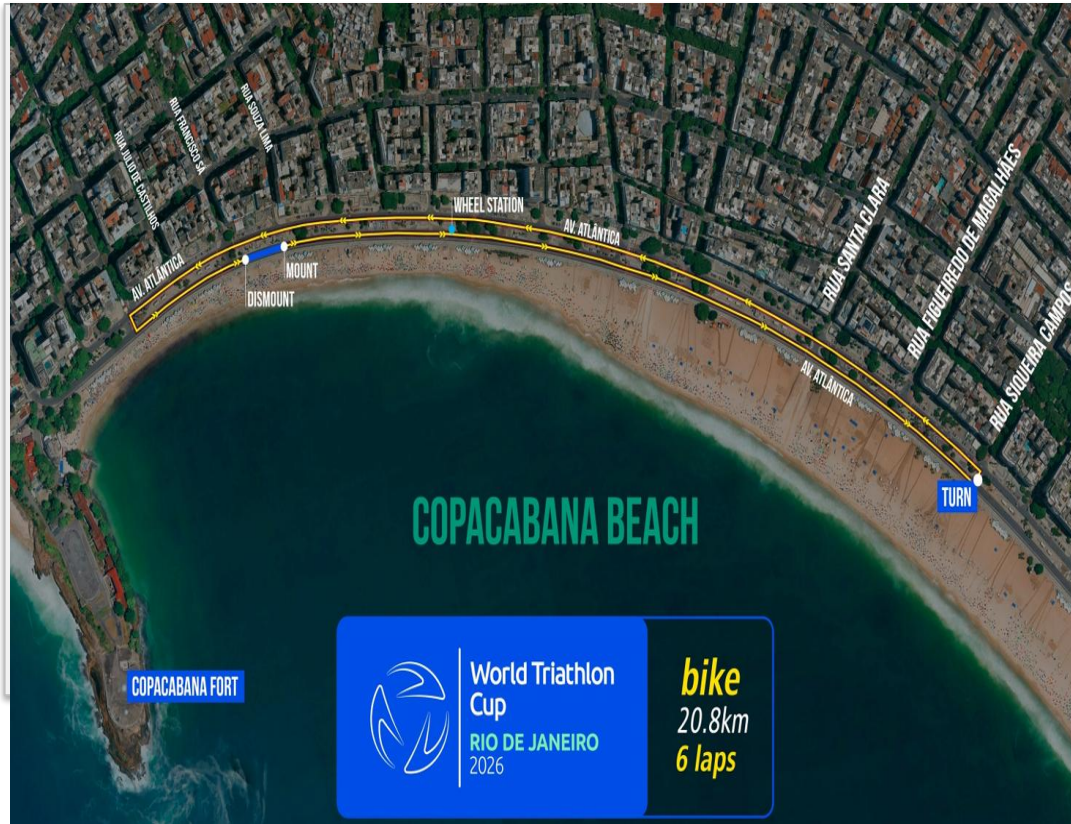
Tactical Notes

- Single 750 m counterclockwise ocean loop off Copacabana Beach. Same course as the 2016 Olympic swim venue
- Beach start with some potential for ocean swell and chop. Protection from the fort and pier though tends to lead to calmer conditions.
- Warm water (22–24 °C). Prepare for non-wetsuit and to manage potential warm water and air temps.
- Exit is close to the entry point. Run up the beach to transition



Bike Course Profile

Rio de Janeiro



20.8 km • 6 × 3.47 km loops

Closed seafront circuit — Avenida Atlântica, Copacabana

Elevation / Lap

65 ft / lap

Total Climb

390 ft

Avg Grade

0%

Max Climb Grade

—

Wind

Beachfront exposed

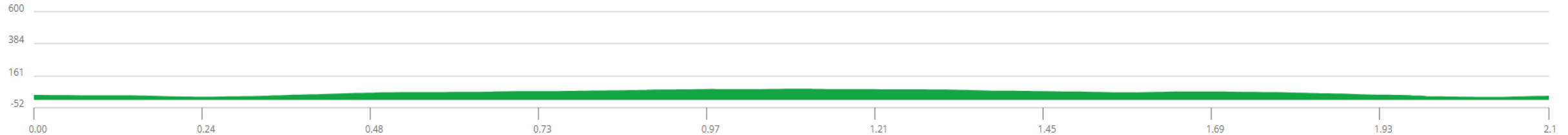
Loops

6 × 3.47 km

Tactical Implications

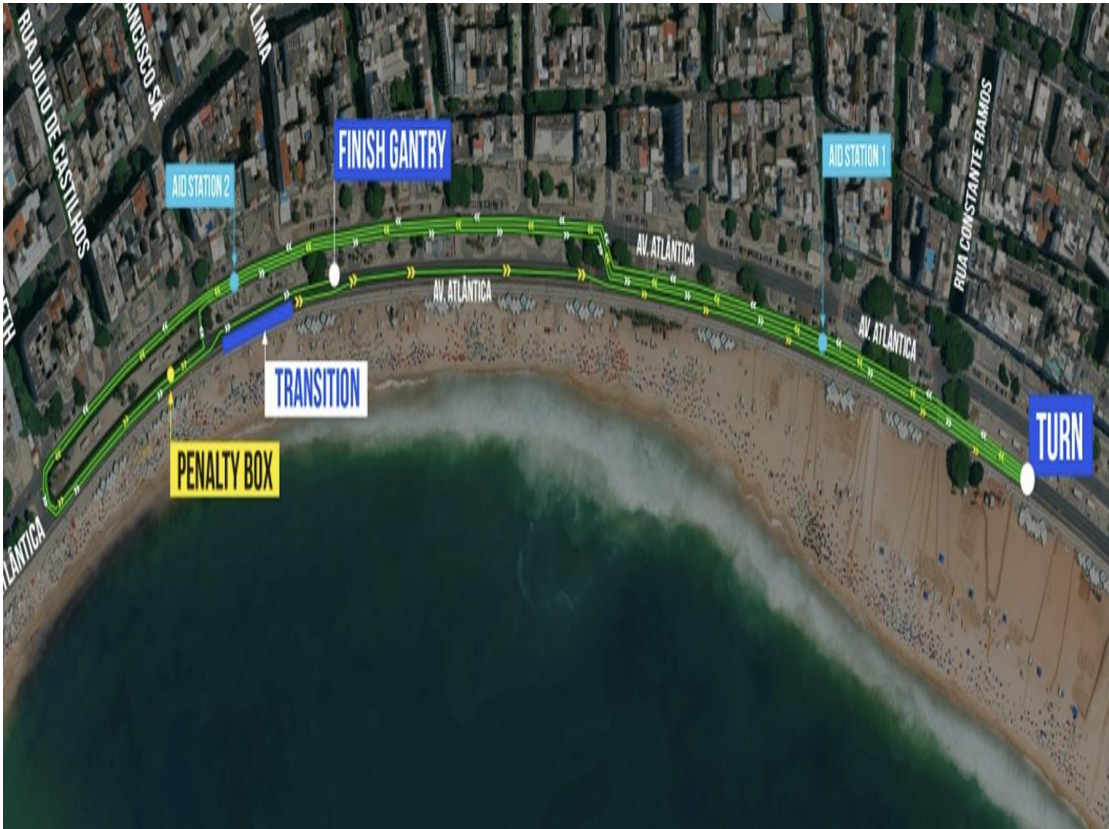
- Flat course with 6 counterclockwise laps along the Copacabana seafront.
- Some potential for Sea-breeze exposure along the beachfront straights can shape pack dynamics
- Dead-flat, high-speed course. Expect large lead packs and a bunch finish onto the run

Elevation



Run Course Profile

Rio de Janeiro



Source: 2026 World Triathlon Cup Rio Athlete's Guide v2.0 (Copacabana)

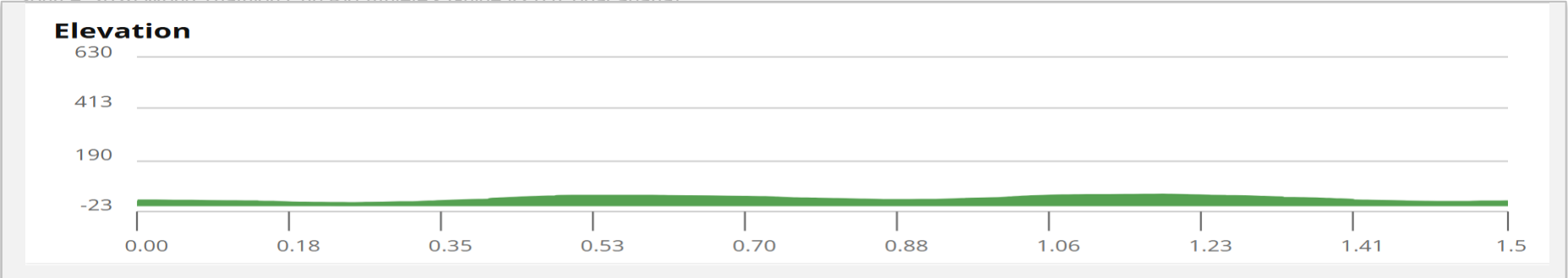
5.0 km • 2 × 2.5 km

Paved seafront promenade — Avenida Atlântica, Copacabana

Distance 5.0 km	Lap Structure 2 × 2.5 km	Total Climb 110ft
Avg Grade 0%	Max ▲ / ▼ ~4%	Heat Risk MODERATE

Tactical Notes

- Flat and fast: 2 counterclockwise laps of 2.5 km along the Copacabana seafront.
- Iconic promenade course featuring the black-and-white Portuguese-wave pavement of Avenida Atlântica. Two short little rises.
- August is Rio winter but typically feature relatively warm conditions.

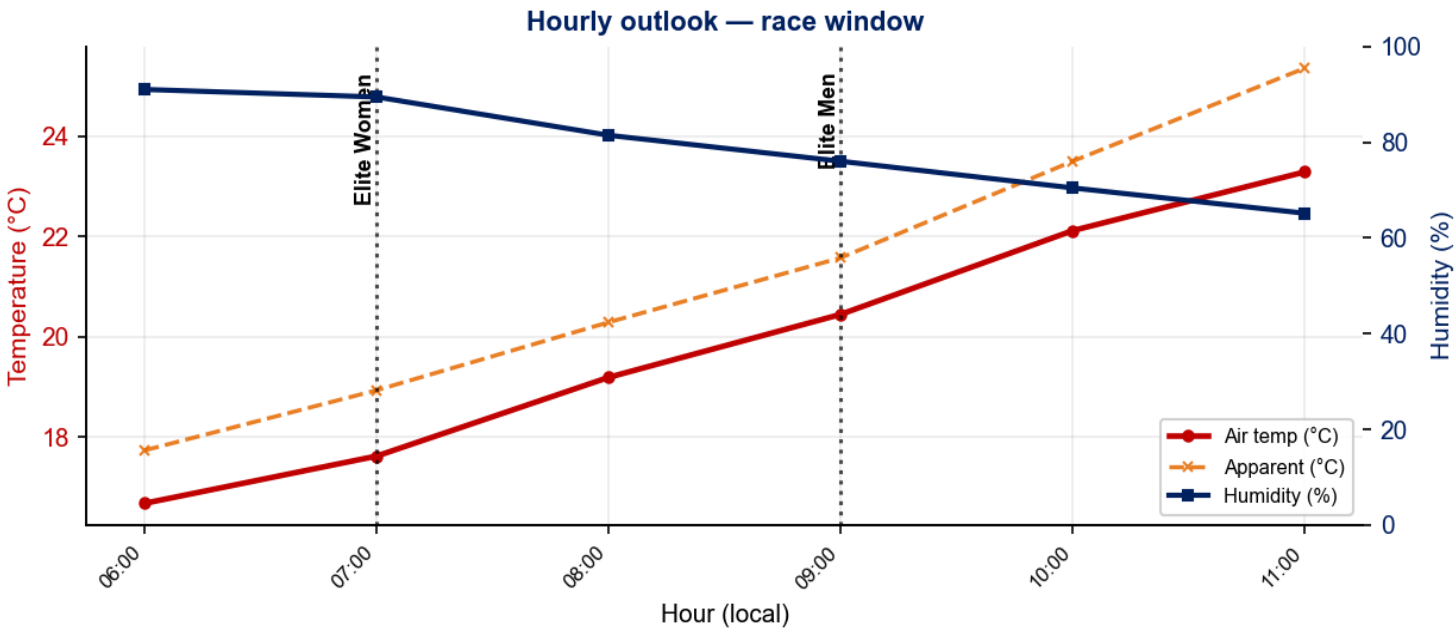


Race-Day Weather Outlook

Rio de Janeiro



2026-08-02 • Historical climatology — same calendar day, 7-year mean



Elite Women — 07:00		
Temperature	Apparent / Heat	Humidity
19.1 °C	20.3 °C	82%
Wind	UV peak	Heat Stress
5.7 km/h	—	LOW

Elite Men — 09:00		
Temperature	Apparent / Heat	Humidity
21.9 °C	23.5 °C	71%
Wind	UV peak	Heat Stress
5.7 km/h	—	LOW

Hydration & Cooling Cues

- Cool to mild outlook. Standard fluids should be sufficient here.
- Men's race runs 2.8 °C hotter than women's. Heavier cooling kit should be utilized.

Data source: Open-Meteo. Forecast will replace climatology once race day is within 16 days. Historical Race Conditions slide shows what actually happened in prior years.

Who to Watch — Rio de Janeiro Race Week



ELITE MEN

Top 10 Ranked on Startlist

Rank	Athlete	Points
17	Diego Moya	3,125
20	Reese Vannerson	2,911
37	Jawad Abdelmoula	2,532
41	Mathis Beaulieu	2,443
49	Manoel Messias	2,250
53	Sullivan Middaugh	2,150
54	Luke Schofield	2,130
55	Braxton Legg	2,124
63	Kazushi Jozuka	1,917
65	Andree Buc	1,889

Returning Podium Athletes on Startlist

No prior race history at this venue.

ELITE WOMEN

Top 10 Ranked on Startlist

Rank	Athlete	Points
23	Djenyfer Arnold	2,837
29	Verena Steinhauser	2,627
34	Manami Hayashi	2,443
37	Danielle Orie	2,432
41	Erika Ackerlund	2,208
43	Mariana Vargem	2,145
45	Sophia Howell	2,111
51	Beatrice Mallozzi	2,028
55	Mako Hiraizumi	1,998
57	Zuzana Michalickova	1,993

Returning Podium Athletes on Startlist

No prior race history at this venue.

Top Swim Threats

Rio de Janeiro



Ranked by Lead Pack % (within 15 s of swim leader) • EWMA swim split (span-5) shown per distance; Sprint = this race • WTCS / World Cup / Continental, last 4 yrs

ELITE MEN						ELITE WOMEN					
#	Athlete	Lead %	EWMA Spr ▶	EWMA Std	Spr/Std	#	Athlete	Lead %	EWMA Spr ▶	EWMA Std	Spr/Std
1	Aiden Longcroft-Harris	97%	9:12	17:51	21/8	1	Vittoria Lopes	100%	10:10	18:56	8/9
2	Ramón Armando Matute	91%	9:12	18:27	17/5	2	Kelly Wetteland	78%	9:34	20:02	8/1
3	Pietro Giovannini	87%	8:48	17:59	10/5	3	Erin McConnell	77%	9:28	—	13/0
4	Dylan McCullough	86%	8:30	17:25	14/7	4	Sophia Howell	71%	9:49	19:46	27/8
5	Diego Moya	77%	8:32	17:46	19/11	5	Cecilia Santamaria Surroca	71%	9:56	19:16	18/10
6	Kevin Tarek Viñuela Gonzalez	74%	8:21	16:54	17/14	6	Moira Miranda	58%	10:13	19:46	15/4
7	Martin Demuth	66%	9:24	17:57	18/14	7	Djenyfer Arnold	52%	10:05	19:32	9/14
8	Luigi Antonio Loddi Vanzella	64%	9:28	18:53	10/1	8	Tjasa Vrtacic	50%	9:19	19:03	14/2
9	Gabriel Terán Carvajal	59%	8:57	18:40	20/7	9	Hollie Elliott	50%	10:06	19:19	16/6
10	Kauê Willy	56%	8:54	18:31	18/7	10	Josephine Seerig	47%	10:15	20:05	12/3
11	Badr Siwane	52%	10:17	18:22	22/9	11	Manami Hayashi	46%	10:09	20:06	20/8
12	Filip Vilenica	50%	8:58	—	4/0	12	Danielle Orie	44%	9:45	19:50	12/6
13	James Corbett	48%	9:40	18:13	19/12	13	Melanie Santos	40%	10:05	19:08	10/10
14	Mitch Kolkman	47%	9:03	17:26	15/4	14	Rafaela Capó	40%	10:08	21:12	6/4

USA World Rankings Snapshot

Rio de Janeiro



As of 2026-07-27 • World Triathlon Rankings • Heading into Rio de Janeiro • Race tier: World Cup

Max Points Available at this Race

Win
500 pts

Podium
427 pts

Top 5
366 pts

Top 10
247 pts

Top 15
167 pts

Top 20
113 pts

ELITE MEN

Rank	Athlete	Points	Curr	Prev
20	Reese Vannerson	2,911	6	6
21	John Reed	2,898	6	6
26	Morgan Pearson	2,712	5	5
48	Seth Rider	2,281	6	5
53	Sullivan Middaugh	2,150	6	6
55	Braxton Legg	2,124	6	6
71	Keller Norland	1,795	6	6
77	Blake Bullard	1,761	6	6
82	Chase McQueen	1,708	6	6
110	Darr Smith	1,452	6	6
112	Zach Leachman	1,433	6	—
130	Porter Middaugh	1,229	6	6
168	Carter Stuhlmacher	1,041	6	4
278	Cole Jamieson	600	4	2
379	Isaac Lamprecht	375	6	2

ELITE WOMEN

Rank	Athlete	Points	Curr	Prev
8	Taylor Spivey	5,256	6	4
16	Gina Sereno	3,205	6	6
26	Gwen Jorgensen	2,700	6	6
37	Danielle Orie	2,432	6	6
41	Erika Ackerlund	2,208	6	6
44	Taylor Knibb	2,129	4	1
56	Naomi Ruff	1,997	6	6
64	Kelly Wetteland	1,843	6	3
84	Kirsten Kasper	1,551	5	2
85	Joy Gill	1,547	6	5
86	Eleanor Beveridge	1,544	6	6
109	Rachel Werking	1,302	6	2
120	Michelle Magnani	1,242	6	6
154	Katie McCune	1,042	6	1
161	Ellison Wolfe	1,002	6	4

Olympic Qualification Pace

Rio de Janeiro



Paris 2024 OQR cutoff (30th): 3,626.69 pts ÷ 12-event cap = 302 pts / event on pace
An athlete who averages ~302 pts per event across their best 12 events is on pace to clear the LA 2028 qualifying threshold.

FINISH POSITION AT EACH TIER THAT HITS 302-PT PACE

Tier	Win pts	Last on-pace pos	First off-pace pos (pts)	Verdict
World Championship Series	1000	#16	#17 (287 pts)	Top 16
World Cup	500	#7	#8 (290 pts)	Top 7

USA MEN								USA WOMEN							
Rk	Athlete	Total	Races	On	Off	Pace	Proj @12	Rk	Athlete	Total	Races	On	Off	Pace	Proj @12
15	Reese Vannerson	1,408	3	3	0	469	5,634	9	Taylor Knibb	2,047	4	4	0	511	6,142
16	Seth Rider	1,341	4	3	1	335	4,023	13	Taylor Spivey	1,795	3	3	0	598	7,180
24	Sullivan Middaugh	1,015	3	2	1	338	4,063	15	Gina Sereno	1,450	4	2	2	362	4,351
30	Morgan Pearson	904	2	1	1	452	5,425	19	Danielle Orie	1,146	4	2	2	286	3,439
35	Chase McQueen	816	4	1	3	204	2,450	24	Naomi Ruff	882	3	1	2	294	3,530
41	Braxton Legg	774	3	1	2	258	3,097	46	Eleanor Beveridge	567	3	0	3	189	2,269
50	John Reed	599	2	1	1	299	3,598	48	Gwen Jorgensen	556	2	1	1	278	3,337
56	Keller Norland	519	1	1	0	519	6,234	58	Kelly Wetteland	462	1	1	0	462	5,550
57	Blake Bullard	513	3	0	3	171	2,055	61	Erika Ackerlund	407	2	0	2	203	2,444
92	Zach Leachman	212	1	0	1	212	2,545	76	Rachel Werking	271	2	0	2	135	1,629
103	Cole Jamieson	169	1	0	1	169	2,038	96	Joy Gill	200	2	0	2	100	1,203

On = events scoring ≥ pace. Off = events < pace. Pace = total breakdown pts ÷ events raced. Proj @12 = current total + (avg pts × remaining events to cap); green if ≥ Paris cutoff. Cutoff estimate: Paris 2024 = 3,627 pts / 12 events = 302 pts/event. Tier positions use a geometric 0.925 points model. Source: World Triathlon rankings database.